



SERVICES SOUGHT

- **Luxury embraces spirituality: Hotels are packaging meditation, ayurveda, rituals, and pilgrimages as premium experiences**
- **A fast-growing market: Wellness and spiritual tourism are emerging as major growth drivers for hospitality**
- **Experience over extravagance: Affluent travellers now seek purpose and inner wellbeing alongside comfort**
- **The big question: Can spirituality be commercialised without losing its authenticity?**
- **Ancient traditions, modern luxury: Brands are blending heritage, mindfulness, and personalised service**

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1. Noor Mahal Palace in Karnal **2.** Pilibhit House in Haridwar **3.** VILEEN Rishikesh, perched above the Ganges in the lower Himalayas

something few destinations can replicate: thousands of years of living spiritual traditions woven into everyday life. Hotels and wellness retreats are now attempting to translate that intangible cultural capital into bespoke guest experiences.

BEYOND WELLNESS

Hoteliers say the post-pandemic years have prompted affluent travellers to prioritise mental well-being and authentic cultural engagement over conspicuous

consumption. Hotels have recognised that spirituality—not merely wellness—offers a powerful competitive advantage. Indian Hotels Company Ltd. (IHCL), India's largest hospitality company, has been among the first to institutionalise this opportunity. Its 'Soulful Abodes' programme spans scores of spiritual destinations, stitching together stays across Taj, SeleQ-tions, Vivanta, and Ginger properties into curated spiritual circuits. Whether exploring the ghats of Varanasi, practicing yoga in Rishi-

kesh, undertaking a pilgrimage to Tirupati, experiencing Sufi traditions in Ajmer or discovering Buddhist monasteries in Gangtok—guests receive location-specific experiences designed around mindfulness, heritage and cultural immersion.

"Spiritual wellness has moved from being a niche interest to becoming one of the strongest growth drivers in Indian hospitality today," says Manoj Mishra, Cluster General Manager-Operations and General Manager, Taj